

FOOD REMEDY API

RE018 -Shopping Cart UX Research and Comparison

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The cart is an important part of Amazon, Woolworths, and Coles where users can check prices, change quantities, remove items, and get help with checking out or making more purchases. Amazon shows off features like "Saved for Later," which lets you move items back into your cart, get price and coupon updates on saved items, and get recommendations based on your interests and past purchases. Woolworths focuses on grocery-specific tools like personal shopper notes, options for substituting items that are out of stock, and lists that can be added to the basket with just one click. Coles' public help section says that customers can change an order after they pay for it until the cut-off time and choose how to handle items that are out of stock.

Cart experience by different platform: -

- **Amazon**

The main focus of Amazon's cart experience is on managing items and re-entering them. The main thing about the cart is that it's not just for checking out; it's also for making temporary decisions. Users can move items to "Saved for Later" and then bring them back later. In the meantime, Amazon changes the prices and availability of coupons for those items. Amazon also uses purchase history, owned items, ratings, and shopping interest signals to make recommendations as part of the overall shopping experience.

- **Woolworths**

Woolworths' cart behavior is more useful and focused on groceries. The service shows personal shopper notes for new items, options for substitutions, and lists that can be added to the basket quickly. This suggests that the cart is more than just a way to choose one item; it also helps with weekly shopping habits, fresh food preferences, and managing availability.

- **Coles**

Coles is like Woolworths in that it treats the cart as part of a grocery order routine that can be changed. Its help section says that users can change an order after paying until the cut-off time, and its substitutions tool says that Coles will try to give you a matching item of equal or greater value when substitutions are allowed. If the substitute costs more, customers only pay the lower shelf price.

Cart layout of the other stores: drawer vs page: -

One big difference is that a drawer or cart panel is used instead of a full cart page. Woolworths and Coles have right-side cart panels or trolley drawers that let users keep shopping while seeing the number of items, quick quantity controls, and checkout buttons. On the other hand, Amazon is more linked to a full cart review pattern, especially because it lets you do things like "Saved for Later" and offers more in-depth recommendation and comparison tools.

From a UX point of view, cart drawers are great for when speed is important and shoppers are still looking around. Full cart pages are better for when users need more space to review, clearer cost inspection, or secondary actions. Research shows that in e-commerce, it's very important to have a good order review, confirmation, and total-cost view. This is especially true since many sites still have trouble with cart and checkout usability.

How users update or remove items from the stores: -

All three platforms allow simple item editing, but the methods are different.

Users can take things off of **Amazon** and put them in Saved for Later. This makes things easier because users don't have to throw away everything. Amazon also shows ways to reorder and get things back, like Buy Again and Lists.

Woolworths lets users control substitutions and add notes for new items by using quantity adjusters and basket/list workflows. This means that "updating" an item means changing the quantity and also changing the way it is fulfilled.

Coles lets you change your order even after you've paid, up until the cut-off time. This is a great grocery store feature because it makes shopping less stressful and lets you add things at the last minute.

Price breakdown presentation of Woolies, Coles and Amazon: -

Price display is important in all carts, but grocery carts usually provide more operational detail. Visual examples from Woolworths and Coles show item pricing, savings tags, item count, and a running total near checkout. Grocery shoppers also need to see substitutions, specials, and final charges that may change during picking.

Research indicates users are keenly aware of true total costs. Hiding shipping, tax, or fees too late in the checkout process leads to confusion and abandonment. The study found many mobile sites still fail to show the total order cost before users enter payment details. This underscores the need for subtotal, discounts, delivery fees, and estimated final total to be visible as early as possible.

Upsell and recommendation patterns: -

It's important for all carts to show prices, but grocery carts usually have more information about how they work. Woolworths and Coles show prices, savings tags, item counts, and a running total near the checkout. Grocery shoppers also need to see substitutions, sales, and final charges that could change while they are shopping.

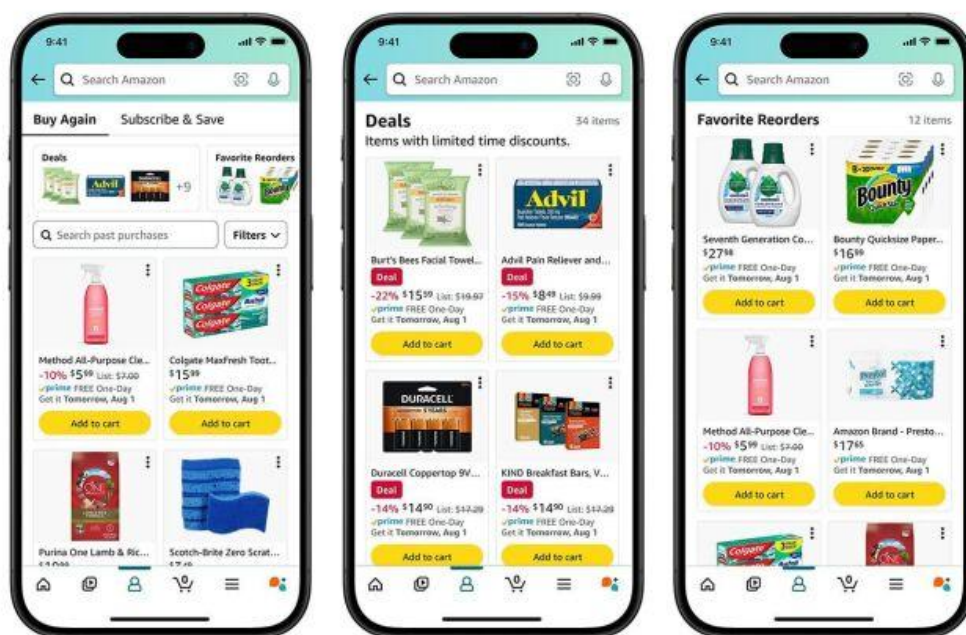
Studies show that users are very aware of the real total costs. If you hide shipping, tax, or fees too late in the checkout process, people will get confused and leave. The research showed that a lot of mobile sites still don't show the total cost of an order before users enter their payment information. This shows how important it is to see the subtotal, discounts, delivery fees, and estimated final total as soon as possible.

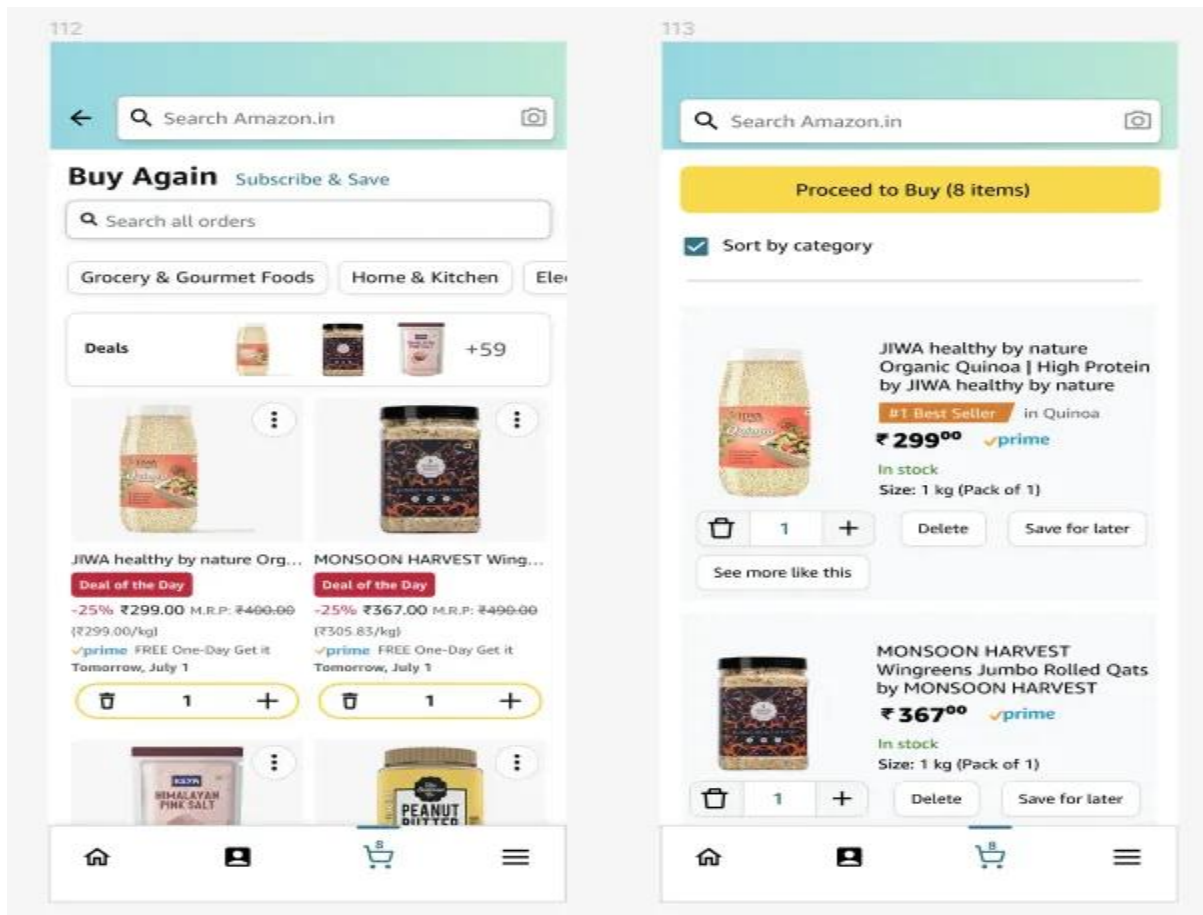
Visual appearances of the stores: -

For coles:

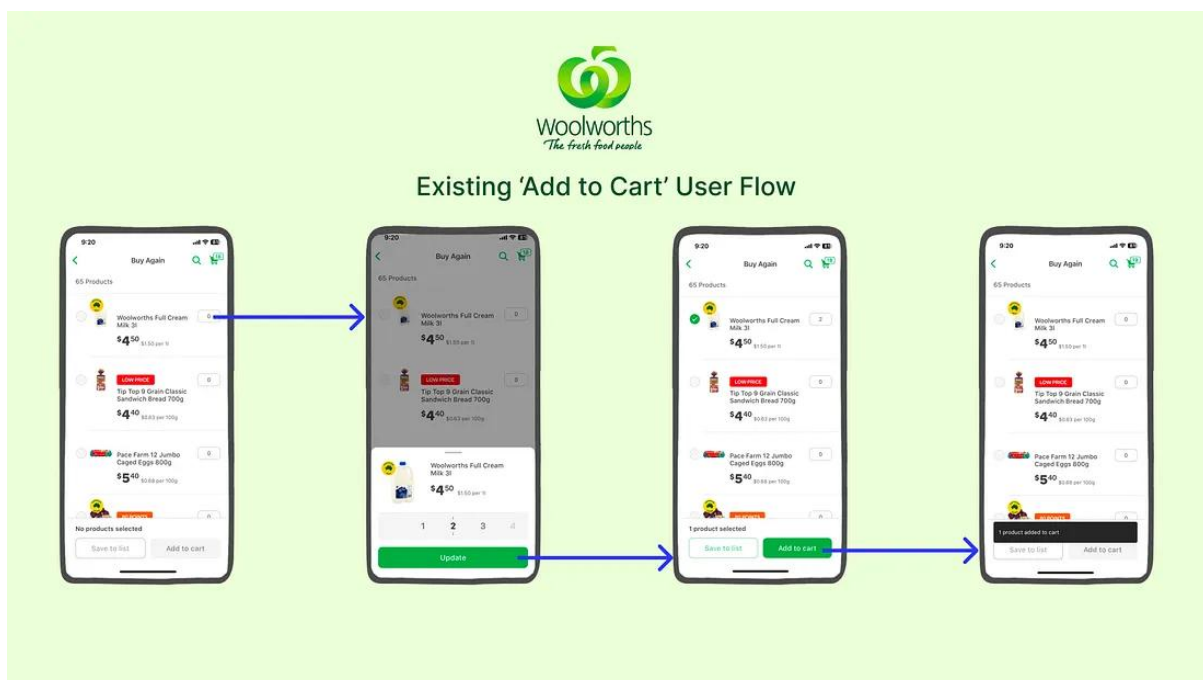


For amazon:





For Woolworths:



Similarities and differences: -

Similarities

All three carts let you do the basic review actions: look at the items you chose, change the quantity, remove or replace items, see the running total, and go to checkout. They all also want to make it easier to buy things by keeping the shopping context instead of starting over.

Differences

Amazon is great at putting off decisions and giving personalized suggestions. **Woolworths** and **Coles** put more emphasis on grocery fulfillment controls, such as substitutions, repeat shopping, and editing operational orders. They also like carts that look more like drawers or trolleys, while Amazon's features suggest a heavier full-cart review model.

Conclusion: -

The main trend is that general e-commerce carts, like the ones on Amazon, let you compare, put off, and recommend products to get more sales. On the other hand, grocery carts from Woolworths and Coles put speed, repeat purchases, substitutions, and flexibility in fulfillment first. A good cart design should combine both approaches: it should let you edit things quickly in context, show you the total costs clearly, let you do light actions to remove or update things, and have well-placed recommendations that help instead of getting in the way.

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Coles

Coles (n.d.) Substitutions in online orders. Available at: <https://www.coles.com.au/help/orders/substitutions> (Accessed: 15 April 2026).